

Uddannelsesmuligheder efter folkeskolen



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Poland. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish. What educational path would you recommend for me?

That's great that you've completed primary school and are fluent in Danish – that gives you a strong foundation. In Denmark, after **9th or 10th grade (folkeskolen)**, you have several options depending on your interests, goals, and how you like to learn.

Here's an overview of the **main educational paths** you can choose from now:

1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (General Upper Secondary Education)

This path prepares you for **university or higher education**.

- **STX (Alment gymnasium)** – Broad education with focus on academic subjects (humanities, science, social studies).
- **HHX (Handelsskole)** – Focus on business, economics, and languages.
- **HTX (Teknisk gymnasium)** – Focus on science, technology, and innovation.
- **HF (Højere forberedelseseksamen)** – A 2-year program more practice-oriented, often for students who prefer a shorter path to higher education.

Good if you:

- Enjoy academic subjects
- Want to go to university
- Are unsure what to do and want to keep your options open

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (VET – Vocational Education and Training)

These combine **school with hands-on work experience (apprenticeships)** and lead directly to a profession.

- Examples: electrician, carpenter, chef, healthcare worker, IT support, mechanic.
- Usually 3–5 years.
- Many also give you the option to continue studying at a university college later.

Good if you:

- Prefer practical learning
- Want to start working sooner

- Know what trade or profession you're interested in
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3. Kombinationsforløb eller 10. klasse

- You can choose to **take 10th grade** to prepare better for your next step.
- Some 10th-grade programs combine school subjects with job experience or special interests (sports, design, etc.).

Good if you:

- Want more time to decide
 - Need to improve academic skills
 - Want to explore a field before committing
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How to Decide?

Ask yourself:

- Do I want to work with my hands, or study theory?
 - Do I want to start working soon, or go to university?
 - What subjects do I enjoy the most?
 - Do I want to study in Denmark only, or maybe also in Poland or abroad later?
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Personal Recommendation

If you're still unsure and want to **keep many doors open**, then I recommend:

👉 **STX** – It's the most general academic route and gives you access to most types of higher education in the future.

But if you already know you're more **practical-minded** or interested in a **specific trade or job**, then:

👉 **VET (Erhvervsuddannelse)** – is a great, respected choice in Denmark with real career potential and often no student debt.

If you tell me a bit more about your **interests or career dreams**, I can give you more specific guidance.